PRELUDE XII

THE crotchets attached to the semiquavers in the right hand are to be held for harmonic purposes only, and not to be marked as if they made themes. On the contrary, all semiquavers (together with notes filling up the flow of semiquavers), in the same hand are melodically connected, even when the notation seems to assign them to different parts. In this kind of keyboard writing the meaning is always double; it takes more than one part to complete the melody, and yet each part has a tendency to develop its own meaning as well. Note particularly the left hand of bar 15, where the complete inversion of the main figure is contained in the last two beats. The most curious case of all is in bar 5, where the second crotchet-stem in the left hand completes an octave too low, the figure in the right hand (compare bar 2).

The sign ~ here always stands for an ordinary trill, to which the turn should be supplied where it is wanting (bar 5, and the left hand of bar 8). The exceptions are in the right-hand of bar 8 and the third beat of bar 10, where only the shortest ornaments are in place.

The *tempo* is a melancholy four in the bar, with a quiet flow which does not suggest eight, though the difference implied would be in accent rather than pace.

At bar 14 we adopt the manifestly best reading of the Kirnberger-Altnikol MSS.

FUGUE XII

THIS Fugue combines its Subject with three Countersubjects in a Quadruple Counterpoint. The highly organised Episodes are all developed from the first figure of the First Countersubject. The Second Countersubject crosses above and below the First in a way that incites the voices on later entries to exchange their themes in mid-course. The Third Countersubject is the simplest and boldest of the three, and should be the more distinctly brought out inasmuch as it is heard only twice (bars 13½-15 and 28-30). As nobody will read this Fugue convincingly at sight unless he can play the *Meistersinger Vorspiel* or Beethoven's last quartets fluently from score, nothing is to be gained by putting such counterpoint on two staves with any regard to a relation between staves and hands. The part-writing is therefore here disentangled in accordance with the themes. From defective analysis even Kroll inserted misleading part-directors in his Peters Edition.

The entries of the Subject (with one or more of its counterpoints) are cardinal events in this Fugue; and the most important are the three entries in the bass, all in the tonic, and all in the lowest possible position (bars 7-10; 27-30 after a very long rest; and, finally, bars 53-56). The ~ given by one of Bach's pupils to the penultimate note of the Subject stands for a well-understood trill, perhaps with turn, and it should be played wherever technically possible.* Where it would make difficulties, as in bars 36, 43, and 55, a short ~ will answer the purpose. In bar 36 it should be given with C♮, not C♭, and in bar 43 with G♮.

The Episodes are related to each other as follows: Episode 1 (the player should indicate the crossing dialogue by making the leading part in bars 10 and 12 stronger than the answering part in bar 11) builds up the first figure of the First Countersubject into imitative falling sequences (bars 10-12). Episode 2 makes similar rising sequences of an inversion of this figure (bars 16-18). Episode 3 makes falling sequences out of a permutation of Episode 2 (bars 22-27). Episode 4 adds a new counterpoint to Episode 1 (bars 30½-33). Episode 5 brings the second figure of the First Countersubject (common to the others also) to combine with the inverted first figure (bars 37-40). Episode 6 brings two fresh counterpoints to bear on the lines of Episode 1 (bars 43½-46). Finally, Episode 7 (bars 50-53) recapitulates Episode 2 with an adroit change which brings it round to the tonic for the final entry.

The *tempo* is broad; scarcely, if at all, faster than the Prelude; but the Countersubjects must be full of rhythmic energy.

* *If the trill is adopted at all. But though conventionally correct, it interferes with breadth of interpretation on the pianoforte.*

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